INTRODUCTION TO BASIC CONCEPTS

1.1. Gender

Gender refers to the socially constructed roles, behaviors, activities and attributes that a given society considers appropriate for men and women or may refer to the different roles and responsibilities attributed to men and women in society. Hence, it does not mean the biological definition of sex as male and female, but how these biological definitions are constructed and interpreted in a social context, subject to historical and cultural change. It is different from sex in that sex refers to the biological and physiological characteristics that define men and women. We can therefore say that gender means the social rather the biological roles, concerns and priorities that are given to men and women and hence a broader concept than the mere biological differences between men and women.

1.2. Development

The concept implies a qualitative change in the way the society carries out its activities, such as through more progressive attitudes and behavior by the population, the adoption of more effective social organizations or more advanced technology which may have been developed elsewhere. Development generally means the improvement of people's lifestyles through improved education, incomes, skills development, housing, water, health, and constructive civic engagement, access to vital information, security and employment. Development should, then, be viewed as a multi-dimensional process involving major changes in social structures, popular attitudes and a national condition of life from unsatisfactory to a more satisfying one.

1.3. Gender Equity

This is the process of allocating resources, programs and decision-making fairly to both males and females and requires we ensure that everyone has access to a full range of opportunities to achieve the social, psychological and physical benefits that come from participating and leading in development activities. Entails the provision of fairness and justice in the distribution of benefits and responsibilities between women and men and it recognizes that women and men have different needs and power and that these differences should be identified and addressed in a manner that rectifies the imbalances between the sexes. It requires that girls and women, boys and men be provided with a full range of activity and program choices that meet their needs, interests and experiences. It is therefore *the process of allocating resources, programs, and decision making*

fairly to both males and females without any gender-based discrimination and addressing any imbalances in the benefits available to males and females.

Gender equity also requires an examination of organizational practices and policies that may disadvantage any gender for full and active participation in development activities. This requires service providers to assess:

- Hiring and recruitment practices to ensure both men and women have leadership roles, and involved in decision-making, and are available as role models for other boys/men and girls/women;
- Resource allocation to determine how budgets are allocated across programs so that specific gender concerns are taken care of.
- Participation rates to evaluate current programs and services to identify potential barriers, and to determine whether programs are truly responsive to gender needs for both men and women.
- Activity programming to assess the types of activities offered for males and females and whether these respond to their needs and further their self-actualization.
- Promotional materials to ensure that neither gender, particularly girls and women are not being excluded or stereotyped in pictures or language.

1.4. Gender equality

Also known as **sex equality**, **sexual equality** or **equality of the genders** refers to the view that men and women should receive equal treatment and should not be discriminated against based on gender, unless there is a sound biological reason for different treatment. Gender equality concerns women and men, and it involves working with men and boys, women and girls to bring about changes in attitudes, behaviors, roles and responsibilities at home, in the workplace, and in the community. Genuine equality means more than parity in numbers or laws on the books; it means expanding freedoms and improving overall quality of life so that equality is achieved without sacrificing gains for males or females.

1.5. Gender Mainstreaming

This is the process of ensuring justice in the distribution of benefits, access to and control of resources, responsibilities, power, opportunities & services across gender (men and women). It ensures women and men, girls and boys have equal chance and access to and control over

resources, opportunities and benefits at all levels. It involves integrating a gender perspective into design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of development policies, plans, programs, projects and legislation at all levels. In simple terms it means taking into consideration of the specific needs of both men and women in any endeavor.

1.6. Gender Sensitivity

This is the act of being aware of the ways people think about gender, which makes people rely less on assumptions about traditional views on the roles of men and women and therefore relying on scientifically accumulated knowledge on the same. It is therefore the understanding and consideration of socio-cultural factors underlying sex-based discrimination. Its hence applies to attitudes that socialize girls and boys into certain behaviors or opportunities e.g. pushing boys into some sports or not expecting girls to do well in certain sports. Gender-sensitive planning uses specific methods and tools to the disadvantaged gender with opportunities for their participation in the development process and as such it is assumed to improve project/organizational outcomes.

1.7. Gender Neutrality

Gender neutrality is the description of the idea that policies, language and other social institutions should avoid distinguishing roles according to people's sex or gender to avoid discrimination. This is for the reason that discrimination may arise from the impression that there are social roles for which one gender is more suited. This can be overcome by for example using gender-neutral language with the aim of neutralizing reference to gender in terms that describe people. For example we can discourage use of gender-specific titles as policeman/policewoman, fireman, chairman, air hostess and instead use gender-neutral terms could be used-police officer, firefighter, flight attendant and chair.

1.8. Gender Blind

A failure to recognize that gender is an essential determinant of social outcomes impacting on projects and policies. A gender-blind approach assumes gender is not an influencing factor in projects, programs or policy. Having the quality of ignoring gender, usually referring to organizations (such as universities) that accept and/or house people together without discriminating on the basis of genderActivities undertaken and services provided without regard to the gender of those who participate. A **gender-blind** (or **unisex**) person is someone who adheres to not distinguishing people by gender. Gender blind people generally advocate gender neutrality

in society such as activities undertaken and services provided without regard to the gender of those who participate.

1.9. Transgender Person

This is anyone whose identity, behavior or attitude falls outside of stereotypical gender norms. It hence refers to an individual whose gender identity does not match their assigned birth gender/sex. Against many misconceptions, being transgender does not imply any specific sexual orientation (attraction to people of a specific gender) and therefore, transgender people may identify as heterosexual or homosexual-being transgender does not mean being homosexual (transgender is not synonymous with homosexuality or heterosexuality). A woman boxer or wrestler may be called transgender because the society does not expect women to engage in such *masculine* sporting activities.

1.10. Gender Identity

Gender identity refers to one's innermost concept of self as male or female or both or neither i.e. how individuals perceive themselves and what they call themselves. As such, one's gender identity can be the same or different than the biological sex assigned at birth. Nonetheless, most people develop a gender identity that matches their biological sex. For some others though, their gender identity is different from their biological or assigned sex. Some other people socially, hormonally and/or surgically change their sex to match their gender identity.

1.11. Gender Role

This refers to the set of tasks, activities, expectations and behaviors assigned to females and males by society and hence refers to the two basic gender roles: Masculine (having the qualities attributed to males) and feminine (having the qualities attributed to females). Sometimes these roles/qualities border on stereotypes since it is what the society expects males and females to exhibit, not necessarily who they think they are. People who step out of their socially assigned or expected gender roles are sometimes referred to as transgender.

1.12. Feminism

Feminism refers to the movements and ideologies aimed at defining, establishing and defending equal political, economic and social rights for women & men. It includes seeking to establish equal opportunities for women and men in education and employment among other spheres of human endeavor (feminists advocate for the rights and equality of men with women. There are several feminist theories that aim to understand the nature of gender inequality by examining women's

social roles and lived experience including, Radical feminism, Marxist feminism, Socialist feminism, Liberal feminism, Black feminism and African feminism

1.13. Patriarchy & Matriarchy

Patriarchy refers to the social system in which society is organized around male authority figures i.e. fathers have authority over women, children and property and are hence the principle decision-makers (the household Supreme Court). It therefore implies the institutions of male rule and privilege that is dependent on female subordination over males. Feminists characterize patriarchy as unjust social system that is oppressive to women and view the patriarchal distinction between masculinity and femininity as synonymous the political difference between freedom and subjection and for this reason, feminists have been criticized as being anti-men. In a nutshell, patriarchy includes all the social mechanisms that reproduce and exert male dominance over female and the opposite is Matriarchy.

1.14. Masculinity & Femininity

Masculinity refers to a set of qualities, characteristics or roles generally considered stereotypically typical of, or appropriate to, a man although women can still do them. Such include trades like masonry, sports like boxing, wrestling, guarding, military service, herding, hunting, bee keeping, etc. On the other hand, **Femininity** refers to a set of attributes, behaviors & roles generally & stereotypically so associated with girls and women. These include cooking, humility, knitting, baby-sitting, nursing, secretarial work, gentleness, empathy, etc. Masculinity and femininity are socially constructed but made up of both socially-defined and biologically-created factors,

1.15. Affirmative Action

A plan of action or programme designed to combat the effects of discrimination against an identified group based on sex, race, age, religion or ethnicity that has been disadvantaged in hiring, promotion, the award of contracts or access to employment opportunities. It can include systems of preferences designed to give additional considerations to individuals who are from groups that have suffered discrimination. The term ‘positive action’ or ‘affirmative action’ is preferable to ‘reverse discrimination’.

WEEK ONE: Introduction and Definition of Terms

Overview of this week's Topic

Definition of the term sex, Definition of the term gender, Differences between gender and sex, Meaning of the term sexual orientation and the types, Definition of gender roles and the traditional gender roles.

This week's objectives

- ✓ To be able to define the term sex and gender
- ✓ To be able to differentiate gender from sex using appropriate examples
- ✓ To demonstrate knowledge on the types of sexual orientation
- ✓ To be able to define gender roles and use relevant examples of gender roles

Sex

Sex refers to the biological characteristics distinguishing male and female.

The definition above empasises male and female differences in terms of chromosomes, anatomy, hormones, reproductive systems and other physiological components.

(For instance, humans have the X and Y chromosomes. The females have XX and the males have XY. Men have the testosterone hormone that is dominant and the females' oestrogen. The sexual organs for males and females are also different (Penis and the vagina respectively). Then you alsofind that the physical structure of men and women is different.)

Sex in other terms refers to physical or physiological differences between males and females, including both primary sex characteristics (the reproductive system) and secondary characteristics (such as height and muscularity).

Gender

Gender refers to those social, cultural and psychological traits linked to males and females through particular social contexts

Gender is a term that refers to social or cultural distinctions associated with being male or female.

Gender refers to the socially constructed characteristics of women and men – such as norms, roles and relationships of and between groups of women and men.

"Gender," also refers to social or cultural distinctions associated with a given sex.

For instance, when babies are born, they are assigned a gender based on their biological sex—male babies are assigned as boys, female babies are assigned as girls, and intersex babies are usually relegated into one category or another.

N.B Scholars generally regard gender as a *social construct*, meaning that it does not exist naturally but is instead a concept that is created by cultural and societal norms. From birth, children are socialized to conform to certain gender roles based on their biological sex and the gender to which they are assigned.

A person's sex, as determined by his or her biology, does not always correspond with his or her gender. **Therefore, the terms** *sex* **and** *gender* **are not interchangeable.**
A baby boy who is born with male genitalia will be identified as male. As he grows, however, he may identify with the feminine aspects of his culture.

Since the term *sex* refers to biological or physical distinctions, characteristics of sex will not vary significantly between different human societies. For example, all persons of the female sex, in general, regardless of culture, will eventually menstruate and develop breasts that can lactate.

Characteristics of gender, on the other hand, may vary greatly between different societies. For example, in American culture, it is considered feminine (or a trait of the female gender) to wear a dress or skirt. However, in many Middle Eastern, Asian, and African cultures, dresses or skirts (often referred to as sarongs, robes, or gowns) can be considered masculine. The kilt worn by a Scottish male does not make him appear feminine in his culture.

Differences between Gender and Sex

- ✓ Gender is a *social construct*, meaning that it does not exist naturally but is instead a concept that is created by cultural and societal norms. The societies are the ones that determine the characteristics that are feminine and those that are masculine. Sex on the other hand is natural - determined after birth mostly by checking the child's genitalia. For example, if a child has a penis automatically it's a boy, if it's a vagina the baby is labeled a girl.
- ✓ Characteristics of sex do not vary significantly in different human societies while characteristics of gender may vary greatly between different societies. For example, in American culture, it is considered feminine (or a trait of the female gender) to wear a dress or skirt. However, in many Middle Eastern, Asian, and African cultures, dresses or skirts (often referred to as sarongs, robes, or gowns) can be considered masculine. The kilt worn by a Scottish male does not make him appear feminine in his culture.

- ✓ Sex makes us male or female; gender makes us masculine or feminine
- ✓ Sex is an ascribed status because a person is born with it, but gender is an achieved status because it must be learned
- ✓ The ascribed status of sex is less likely to be altered than the achieved status of gender. For example, all persons of the female sex, in general, regardless of culture, will eventually menstruate and develop breasts that can lactate. One can learn for instance to be masculine even if they were socialized to be feminine

Sexual Orientation

Sexual orientation refers to a person's emotional and sexual attraction to a particular sex (male or female).

Sexual orientation is typically divided into four categories:

- ✓ *Heterosexuality* **is** the attraction to individuals of the opposite sex
- ✓ *Homosexuality* **is** the attraction to individuals of one's own sex
- ✓ *Bisexuality* **is** the attraction to individuals of either sex
- ✓ *Asexuality* **is where there is no** attraction to either sex

Heterosexuals and homosexuals may also be referred informally as "straight" and "gay," respectively.

Gender Roles

The term **gender role** refers to society's concept of how men and women are expected to act and how they should behave. These roles are based on norms, or standards, created by society.
Gender roles are the expected attitudes and behavior a society associates with each sex – females and males.
As we grow, we learn how to behave from those around us. In this socialization process, children are introduced to certain roles that are typically linked to their biological sex.

Gender roles are cultural – they determine how males and females should think, speak, dress and interact within the context of society

Gender roles adopted during childhood normally continue into adulthood
Children then receive parental approval when they conform to gender expectations and adopt culturally accepted and conventional roles

In Canadian culture, **masculine roles** are usually associated with strength, aggression, and dominance, while **feminine roles** are usually associated with passivity, nurturing, and subordination.

Role learning starts with socialization at birth. Even today, our society is quick to outfit male infants in blue and girls in pink, even applying these colour-coded gender labels while a baby is in the womb.

One way children learn gender roles is through **play**. Parents typically supply boys with trucks, toy guns, and superhero paraphernalia, which are active toys that promote motor skills, aggression, and solitary play.

Girls are often given dolls and dress-up apparel that foster nurturing, social proximity, and role play. Studies have shown that children will most likely choose to play with “gender appropriate” toys (or same-gender toys) even when cross-gender toys are available because parents give children positive feedback (in the form of praise, involvement, and physical closeness) for gender-normative behaviour (Caldera, Huston, and O’Brien 1998).

The drive to adhere to masculine and feminine gender roles continues later in life. Men tend to outnumber women in professions such as law enforcement, the military, and politics. Women tend to outnumber men in care-related occupations such as child care, health care, and social work.

These occupational roles are examples of typical Canadian male and female behaviour, derived from our culture’s traditions. Adherence to them demonstrates fulfillment of social expectations but not necessarily personal preference (Diamond 2002).

Gender roles shape individual behavior not only by dictating how people of each gender should behave, but also by giving rise to penalties for people who don't conform to the norms.

While it is somewhat acceptable for women to take on a narrow range of masculine characteristics without repercussions (such as dressing in traditionally male clothing), men are rarely able to take on more feminine characteristics (such as wearing skirts) without the risk of harassment or violence. This threat of punishment for stepping outside of gender norms is especially true for those who do not identify as male or female. Transgender, gender queer, and other gender-nonconforming people face discrimination, oppression, and violence for not adhering to society's traditional gender roles.

People who identify as gay, lesbian, bisexual, or queer are also ostracized for breaking the traditional gender norm of who a person of a given sex "should" be attracted to. Even people who identify as cisgender (identifying with the sex they were assigned at birth) and straight (attracted to the opposite sex) face repercussions if they step outside of their gender role in an obvious way.

Examples of Traditional Gender Roles

MEN	*WOMEN*
Should become Doctors	*Should become Nurses*
They are Bread winners	*Stay at home to take care of the children*
Play with trucks	*Play with dolls*
Play football, rugby, hockey	*Play netball, volleyball*
Good at Maths and sciences	*Good at English*
Dominant	*Submissive*

Summary

From the subtopics above, we have defined sex and also gender. We have also differentiated them and even used applicable examples. In addition, we have explained what sexual orientation means and the types that exist and lastly we have defined gender roles and even given examples of the traditional gender roles.

Lastly, there are several terms that we have not yet defined but we will define them next week as we wind up on the introduction and definition of terms

WEEK ONE: DEFINITION OF TERMS

Overview of this week's Topic

This week, we continue with the definition of the terms: Gender identity; stereotypes; Sexism; Gender socialization; Gender equality; gender equity; gender inequality; Gender analysis; Gender awareness; Gender sensitivity; Gender discrimination; Homophobia; Gender mainstreaming; mainstreaming gender perspective and empowerment.

This week's objectives

- ✓ To define gender identity and differentiate between the transgendered and transsexuals individuals
- ✓ To describe forms of sexism that exists in the society
- ✓ To differentiate between, Gender equality, equity and inequality
- ✓ To demonstrate knowledge of gender analysis, awareness and sensitivity
- ✓ To describe how homophobia occurs in the society
- ✓ To understand gender mainstreaming and empowerment.

Gender Identity

Gender identity is the extent to which one identifies as being either masculine or feminine (Diamond 2002). It refers to the degree to which an individual sees herself or himself as feminine or masculine.

Gender identity is an individual's self-conception of being male or female based on his or her association with masculine or feminine gender roles.

Some people are born with ambiguous sex characteristics and may be assigned one sex at birth but develop a different identity related to gender.
Some cultures allow people to move freely between genders regardless of their biological sex

NB: Gender identity is not a stable, fixed trait – rather it is socially constructed and may vary overtime for an individual

Individuals who identify with the role that is the opposite of their biological sex are called **transgendered**. Transgendered males, for example, have such a strong emotional and psychological connection to the feminine aspects of society that they identify their gender as female. The parallel connection to masculinity exists for transgendered females.

Transgendered individuals who wish to alter their bodies through medical interventions such as surgery and hormonal therapy—so that their physical being is better aligned with gender identity—are called **transsexuals**. They may also be known as male-to-female (MTF) or female-to-male (FTM) transsexuals.

Not all transgendered individuals choose to alter their bodies: many will maintain their original anatomy but may present themselves to society as the opposite gender. This is typically done by adopting the dress, hairstyle, mannerisms, or other characteristic typically assigned to the opposite gender. It is important to note that people who cross-dress, or wear clothing that is traditionally assigned to opposite gender, are not necessarily transgendered. Cross-dressing is typically a form of self-expression, entertainment, or personal style, not necessarily an expression against one's assigned gender (APA 2008).

Stereotypes

Stereotypes are oversimplified/overgeneralizing notions about members of a group.

Gender stereotyping involves over generalizing about the attitudes, traits, or behavior patterns of women or men. For example, women may be thought of as too timid or weak to ride a motorcycle. Gender stereotypes form the basis of sexism

Sexism

Sexism refers to prejudiced/biased beliefs that value one sex over another or the prejudiced beliefs that value males over females.

Common forms of sexism in modern society include gender-role expectations, such as expecting women to be the caretakers of the household. Sexism also includes people's expectations of how members of a gender group should behave. For example, women are expected to be friendly, passive, and nurturing; when a woman behaves in an unfriendly or assertive manner, she may be disliked or perceived as aggressive because she has violated a gender role (Rudman, 1998). In contrast, a man behaving in a similarly unfriendly or assertive way might be perceived as strong or even gain respect in some circumstances.

Sexism varies in its level of severity. In parts of the world where women are strongly undervalued, young girls may not be given the same access to nutrition, health care, and education as boys. Further, they will grow up believing that they deserve to be treated differently from boys.

M Sexism can exist on a societal level such as in hiring, employment opportunities, and education. In the United States, women are less likely to be hired or promoted in male-dominated professions such as engineering, aviation, and construction (Blau, Ferber, & Winkler, 2010; Ceci & Williams, 2011).

Gender Socialization

Gender socialization is the process of learning the social expectations and attitudes associated with one's sex.

Gender Equality

Gender equality is achieved when women and men enjoy the same rights and opportunities across all sectors of society, including economic participation and decision-making, and when the different behaviours, aspirations and needs of women and men are equally valued and favoured.

Gender equality is measured by looking at the representation of men and of women in a range of roles

"Gender equality requires equal enjoyment by women and men of socially-valued goods, opportunities, resources and rewards."

In other words, gender equality refers to equal access to social goods, services and resources and equal opportunities in all spheres of life for both men and women.

When there is gender inequality, it is women that are more likely to be disadvantaged and marginalized; but we should not ignore the negative impact that gender inequality can have on men as well.

For example, societal norms regarding the appropriate behaviour for men tend to put them under pressure as regards the need to provide materially for their family, and also deny them opportunities of being more nurturing towards their children and wife.

Therefore gender equality is the concern of all and changes must be brought about for both men and women. However, this is not to say that men and women are equally affected by gender inequality. It remains true that women have the greater share of disadvantages.

However, gender equality, as defined above, does not often result in equal outcomes for men and women. Being given the same chances in life is not sufficient to bring about true equality. Women and men have different needs and experiences and accommodation should be made for these differences. For example, giving boys and girls equal access to all the courses offered in a school may not result in girls taking advantage of this opportunity if some courses are predominantly filled with male students and have only male teachers. There is still the unfortunate tendency to consider male norms as a measure for women's position.

Providing women and men with the same opportunities is the first step; but for true gender equality to be achieved there is a need for gender equity.

Gender Equity

Gender equity is the process of being fair to women and men." (UNFPA)

Women and men should not only be given equal access to resources and equal opportunities, but they should also be given the means of benefiting from this equality. This is where the concept of ‘gender equity' comes into play.

Gender equity implies fairness in the way women and men are treated. The different life experiences and needs of men and women are taken into consideration and compensation is made for women's historical and social disadvantages. The lower status of women in society often constitutes a handicap and provisions should be made to redress this inequality before they can take advantage of the opportunities provided. Gender equity thus serves to level the playing field and empower women. Therefore, we can say that equity is essential to achieve true equality.

Gender Inequality

Gender inequality can be defined as allowing people different opportunities due to perceived differences based solely on issues of gender. Gender discrimination is the prejudicial treatment of an individual or group due to gender. Gender inequality and discrimination are generally discussed as pertaining to women, but anyone can experience gender-based inequality or discrimination.

Gender Analysis

Gender analysis

Examines the differences in women's and men's lives, including those which lead to social and economic inequity for women, and applies this understanding to policy development and service delivery. It is concerned with the underlying causes of these inequities. It aims to achieve positive change for women

Gender analysis recognizes that:

- ✓ women's and men's lives and therefore experiences, needs, issues and priorities are different
- ✓ women's lives are not all the same; the interests that women have in common may be determined as much by their social position or their ethnic identity as by the fact they are women
- ✓ women's life experiences, needs, issues and priorities are different for different ethnic groups
- ✓ the life experiences, needs, issues, and priorities vary for different groups of women (dependent on age, ethnicity, disability, income levels, employment status, marital status, sexual orientation and whether they have dependants)
- ✓ different strategies may be necessary to achieve equitable outcomes for women and men and different groups of women

Gender analysis aims to achieve **equity**, rather than equality.

Gender analysis provides a basis for robust analysis of the differences between women's and men's lives, and this removes the possibility of analysis being based on incorrect assumptions and stereotypes.

Gender Awareness

Gender awareness is an understanding that there are socially determined differences between women & men based on learned behavior, which affect their ability to access and control resources. This awareness needs to be applied through gender analysis into programmes, policies and evaluation.

Gender awareness is the ability to view society from the perspective of gender roles and how this has affected women's needs in comparison to the needs of men.

Gender Sensitivity

Gender sensitivity is translating this awareness into action in the design of development policies, programs and budgets.

Gender sensitivity is the act of being sensitive to the ways people think about gender. Gender sensitivity tries to ensure that people rely less on assumptions about traditional and outdated views on the roles of men and women.

Gender Discrimination

Gender discrimination is also known as gender bias.

It is a situation in which someone is treated less well because of their sex, usually when a woman is treated less well than a man:

Gender discrimination means differential treatment based on a person's gender or sex, which more often affects girls and women. Because of gender discrimination, girls and women do not have the same opportunities as boys and men for education, meaningful careers, political influence, and economic advancement.

Gender discrimination usually results in women experiencing social inequality but it also occurs when people are targeted because they do not conform to gender norms related to their biological sex.

Homophobia

Homophobia is a range of negative attitudes and feelings towards lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgendered and **intersex** people which denies their humanity, dignity and personhood.

For instance, a society is **homophobic** when it is structured so that heterosexuality is socially and institutionally reinforced.

Gender Mainstreaming

Gender mainstreaming involves bringing the contribution, perspectives and priorities of both women and men to the centre of attention in the development arena in order to inform the design, implementation and outcomes of policies and programs. It is a critical strategy not only in the pursuit of gender equality – a development goal in its own right – but also in the achievement of other development goals, including economic ones. Indeed, overlooking relevant gender factors in macroeconomic policies and institutions can undermine the successful outcome of those very same policies and institutions".

Mainstreaming Gender Perspective

Mainstreaming gender perspective is the process of assessing the implications for women and men of any planned action, including legislation, policies or programs, in all areas and at all levels. It is a strategy for making women's as well as men's concerns and experiences an integral dimension of the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of policies and programs in all political, economic and societal spheres so that women and men benefit equally and inequality is not perpetuated. The ultimate goal is to achieve gender equality.

Empowerment

Empowerment refers to increasing the spiritual, political, social or economic strength of individuals and communities. It often involves the empowered developing confidence in their own capacities.

Empowerment is probably the totality of the following or similar capabilities:

1.Having decision-making power of their own
2.Having access to information and resources for taking proper decision
3.Having a range of options from which you can make choices (not just yes/no, either/or.)

4.Ability to exercise assertiveness in collective decision making
5.Having positive thinking on the ability to make change
6.Ability to learn skills for improving one's personal or group power.
7. Ability to change others' perceptions by democratic means.
8. Involving in the growth process and changes that is never ending and self-initiated
9. Increasing one's positive self-image and overcoming stigma

Summary

From the subtopics above, we have defined Gender identity; stereotypes; Sexism; Gender socialization; Gender equality; gender equity; gender inequality; Gender analysis; Gender awareness; Gender sensitivity; Gender discrimination; Homophobia; Gender mainstreaming; mainstreaming gender perspective and empowerment.